

171 Go cloud-spotting

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Just like people, clouds come in all shapes and sizes. Some are white and fluffy—like cotton balls. Others are gray and sheetlike. Go cloud-spotting and see how many cloud types you can identify.

What you need

- Your eyes
- Clouds
- Guide to cloud types



Cumulonimbus:
large, tall thundercloud

Cirrus: high, wispy fibers

Cirrocumulus:
high, small, fluffy

Cirrostratus:
high, thin sheets

Alto cumulus:
mid-level, small, fluffy

Altostratus: mid-level,
layered sheets

Stratocumulus: low,
slightly fluffy sheets

Cumulus: low, fluffy,
white or gray pillows

- 1 Start by looking at the cloud's shape. Is it puffy and round, spread out in a sheet, or wispy, like smoke? Is it hanging low in the sky or so high you can hardly see it?

172 Forecast the weather

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A pinecone can act as a simple barometer. Set it on a shady windowsill. If the scales close, the humidity is high and it might rain. If it's open, the air is dry and the weather will be clear.



RAIN



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